

Trubel

QR-code album that scans guests' camera rolls automatically after the event. Two revenue streams: sub + 4K consumable.

What it is

Trubel is an iOS + Android photo-album app with QR-code magic. You host a hangout (birthday, bachelorette, housewarming, flatshare party), generate a QR card, every guest scans it and just takes photos normally with their phone camera. After the event the app scans your guests' camera roll automatically within the correct time window (optional GPS radius) and collects every photo into a single shared album. Optional: any host or guest can buy a 4K download of the full album as a one-time consumable.

Who it is for

Gen-Z friend-group leaders, party hosts, bachelorette and birthday planners, festival groups, study-abroad cohorts. Audience skews 18-28, heavily TikTok-leaning, iPhone-dominant (~80%). Creators who sit well: birthday-recap creators, bachelorette planners, college lifestyle accounts, flatshare content, festival vloggers, camera-roll-aesthetic accounts.

Key features

- QR-card hosting: per-event QR card design, guests scan once on arrival, no app account needed to contribute.
- Automatic camera-roll scan: pulls every photo from guests' rolls within the time window (+ optional GPS radius), no manual upload chasing.
- Shared album per event: every member sees every photo as it lands, comment + react inline.
- World-Map public pin (Premium): turn the album into a discovery pin so friends-of-friends can find it.
- 4K full-album download (one-time, 1.99 USD): one tap, the full event in print resolution.
- Multi-event hosting: birthdays, trips, parties - switch albums without re-onboarding guests each time.

Business model

- Two revenue streams: recurring Premium sub + one-time 4K-album consumable.
- Free tier is generous: 3 active albums, 20 photos per album, 4 members per album.
- Premium unlocks: unlimited albums, unlimited photos, unlimited members, World-Map pin.
- Standalone consumable: 4K album download 1.99 USD per album (no sub required, every album-host can pay one-time).
- Free Lifetime Premium for onboarded affiliates, no posting obligation.

Pricing

- Premium: ~5 EUR / month or ~30 EUR / year (~ one month free vs monthly).
- 4K Album: 1.99 USD per album, one-time consumable per album.
- ASC live since May 2026; affiliate share is always 50% of the then-current price on both streams.

Market gap - what was missing

Group-event photo collection has been broken for 10+ years. The dominant pattern ("send me your pics" group chat) loses 70% of the photos by the third day after the event. Web-based competitors (POV.contact, FridaySnap, Lapse, JOY) all require guests to install something or upload manually - friction every host knows kills participation. Apple's Shared Albums work only for iPhone users and require account creation. Trubel's automatic camera-roll scan with a privacy-windowed time + GPS filter is genuinely a category-of-one: guests just take photos normally with their phone camera, the app does the collection after the event. The 4K-download consumable is the second unlock - it lets the album become a tangible, archival object instead of a fading group chat.

Why now

Two structural shifts make this work. First, iOS PhotoKit and Android MediaStore APIs reached a maturity in 2024-2025 where time + location-windowed reads are reliable and battery-cheap. Second, Gen-Z's relationship with the camera roll has shifted from "private archive" to "shareable artefact" (driven by TikTok carousel format and BeReal-style aesthetic). The audience is primed for an app that treats group events as memory artefacts rather than as group-chat noise. Add the 4K-consumable rail and a single big-event creator can monetise twice on the same content.

Affiliate compensation

- 50% of net Premium subscription revenue for 24 months from each attributed user's first paid month.
- 30-day refund holdback before payout becomes claimable (Apple / Google refund window).
- 50 EUR minimum payout, monthly, via Wise.
- Free Lifetime Premium for onboarded affiliates (no posting obligation).
- Per-handle dashboard with live click / install / sub / earning split, no agency layer.

How tracking works - DIY attribution stack

Most affiliate stacks ride on top of Branch.io, AppsFlyer or a similar paid attribution SDK. We built our own. Those tools charge per attributed install, they add a third party to the user's first-launch experience, and they make influencer payouts opaque. Trubel has the additional wrinkle of two revenue streams (Premium sub + 4K-album consumable), and both need to attribute to the same handle. Here is what runs in each stage.

Why we built our own instead of Branch.io

Three reasons. (1) Cost: Branch.io / AppsFlyer charge 0.20-0.40 USD per attributed install at our volume tier, which would have absorbed 8-12% of the affiliate payout pool. With DIY we keep that for affiliates. (2) Privacy: each extra SDK reads first-launch context - another vendor with first-touch user data we did not want to add. Apple's App Tracking Transparency has made probabilistic fingerprinting unreliable since iOS 14.5. (3) Transparency: when a number looks wrong, we read our own code in 10 minutes instead of debugging a vendor black box.

Android: Google Play install-referrer

Android gives us the cleanest path. When a user taps your link, the Google Play Store install carries the original referrer string through to first launch via the Play Install Referrer API. On first launch the app reads `getInstallReferrer().getInstallReferrer()`, we parse the handle out of it, and write an attribution row alongside the install event. Deterministic. No fingerprinting. No clipboard.

iOS warm (app already installed)

If the user already has Trubel installed, iOS routes the tap through a Universal Link directly into the app with the handle in the URL path. We register `trubel.space/i/*` as a Universal Link, Apple's CDN serves the `apple-app-site-association` JSON, the OS routes the tap. Deep-link handler reads the URL path, extracts the handle, writes the attribution row.

iOS cold (~99% of creator traffic)

The hard case - and ~99% of creator traffic in Trubel's Gen-Z audience - is iOS cold install. iOS gives the freshly installed app no context about how it was reached. Branch.io's whole business is solving this with device-fingerprinting heuristics that became unreliable after iOS 14.5. We do it differently. When a user taps your link in Safari, our redirect chain hits `trubel.space/i/[handle]`. That page writes a short-lived JSON token to the clipboard (handle, timestamp, app-key, HMAC-SHA256 signature) before redirecting to the App Store. After install, on first launch, the app reads the clipboard once, parses the JSON, verifies the signature, accepts the token if fresh and signed, and writes the attribution row. The user sees no extra screen when it works.

Optional first-open confirmer

Optional fallback. On first open, after we've read whatever the clipboard provided, the app can show a single confirmation: "Invited by @[suggested-handle]? Yes / No". Pre-filled with whatever the clipboard suggested; if empty, the user can type. Most users tap Yes. Trubel currently runs the confirmer ON because Gen-Z guests sometimes copy other content (TikTok URLs, song titles) between tap and install, and the explicit confirm catches that edge case.

RevenueCat webhook -> payout queue

Both revenue streams flow through RevenueCat - the recurring Premium sub AND the 4K-album consumable. RC normalises both into the same webhook event format. When `INITIAL_PURCHASE`, `RENEWAL`, `NON_RENEWING_PURCHASE` (the consumable event), `PRODUCT_CHANGE`, or `CANCELLATION` fires, RC posts JSON to our Supabase Edge function `affiliate-rc-webhook`. The function: (1) verifies RC signature, (2) idempotency-check against `processed_webhook_events`, (3) looks up the user's attribution row, (4) computes 50% of the net revenue after Apple's or Google's cut (typically 30% for consumables, 15% for subs over 12 months), (5) credits `affiliate_earnings` with handle, app, product-key (Premium sub or 4K-album), gross, cut, net, our-share, holdback-until, source event ID.

Holdback -> batch -> Wise

Each credited earning enters a 30-day refund holdback. After holdback expires the row flips to `claimable`. A `pg_cron` job runs `build_payout_batch()` on the 5th of each month: groups all `claimable` rows per affiliate handle (sub + consumable revenues combined), applies the 50 EUR minimum-payout threshold, creates one `payout_batches` row per qualifying affiliate, enqueues a job in `wise_dispatch_queue`. `wise-dispatch` calls Wise's v3 transfer API with the affiliate's stored Wise recipient ID. For Trubel specifically, the 4K-album consumable means a single big-event reel can attribute 5-20 consumable purchases (one per guest who buys the album) on top of the sub. Those land as separate rows in the earnings ledger and roll into the same monthly batch.

getklar.org

What you see on your dashboard

Your dashboard at getklar.org/dashboard shows the funnel transparently: clicks per day/week/month, install

Why this works as an affiliate pitch

Birthday and bachelorette content has explosive Gen-Z reach. The pain ("send me your pics" group chats that die in 4 days) is universal and concrete. Trubel's automatic camera-roll scan is genuinely a category-of-one - competitors are all web-app-centric, Trubel is native. Two revenue rails (sub + consumable) both pay the affiliate, so high-emotion-moment audiences (festivals, weddings) monetise twice on the same content.

On posts with affiliate link: #ad / #sponsored / Paid Partnership (FTC, EU disclosure law).